Decentralized curation

Private incentives, credible consensus, public benefit

Institute of Open Science Practices (IOSP) 2026, Leiden · Wednesday 14 October 2026, 14:00 to 15:20

Informed judgment, public purpose

Reward assessment and correction to support better funding decisions. Credible consensus means evidence-informed judgments under an explicit policy, with usable correction paths. It is an intermediate objective, not certified truth. Public benefit needs separate evidence about outcomes for affected people.

The full mechanism

1. **Set terms:** funding budget, public policy and fixed economic rules.
2. **Nominate:** identify a beneficiary, publish evidence, request a weight and deposit the funding asset.
3. **Judge relevance:** stake-backed, randomly drawn juries seal and reveal scores under the policy.
4. **Appeal:** fund a larger jury. The deepest completed round supplies the score and the reference for grading every round.
5. **Fund:** eligible weights split the continuing flow after any required holdback.
6. **Challenge and revisit:** once scored, claims can face external arbitration when no relevance case is open. Re-scoring can change future funding.

Weight is not a funding share

Effective weight = the lower of requested weight and curated score. Funding shares depend on relative weights. Try the NumPy worked example: change a jury score and watch all funding shares update. Its evidence is real; the funding values are illustrative.

Dependencies and authority

Good outcomes need a defensible policy, informed jurors, usable evidence and affordable challenges. Stake does not certify expertise; agreement does not establish public benefit.

Where configured, a temporary circuit-breaker holder may permanently stop future accrual once, before expiry. They cannot take prior accrual.

Today: experience one layer

Read the policy, score alone, seal, then reveal. This hosted game uses equal seats and points. Its band follows the mean and standard deviation; rewards depend on closeness. At essentially zero spread, distance forfeits switch off.

Workshop simplification: each round with opened scores pays the full base reward, even when those scores all agree.

Keep score proofs private. This game's reporting bounty is absent from the current full-system contracts. The live jury game does not run accuracy disputes, jury selection, appeals or a funding stream.

The workshop policy

How much does this nominee's completed and maintained work underpin how research is done, shared and kept, now?

Docket: Inkscape, Linux, PDF, LaTeX, arXiv, NumPy.

From experience to evidence

What did you judge? What did the game reward? What would justify another jury? This exercise exposes questions; it does not demonstrate better decisions or resistance to collusion.

Arrow is a planned precursor experiment at Octant: invited experts score a real docket under a published policy. It assumes honesty, competence and non-collusion; it does not validate the full permissionless system. octant.build

Try, read, stay in touch

The room

Published preprint

Mailing list

Room: decentralized-curation.0xferit.workers.dev/r/leiden

Join: decentralized-curation.0xferit.workers.dev/join/

Published preprint, version 1.1.0: doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23298493.

October 11 manuscript: private incentives, public benefit and explicit limits.

Decentralized Curation research by Ferit Tunçer. Supported by Octant.

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